

**Tomorrow travel**

We explore the possibilities that await us in the future of transportation

**Bye bye Voyager 1**

Huge changes in the readings sent back, indicate Voyager 1 has indeed gone beyond the heliosphere. <http://dgit.in/15rMIwf>

# Star Trek

# Reality Check

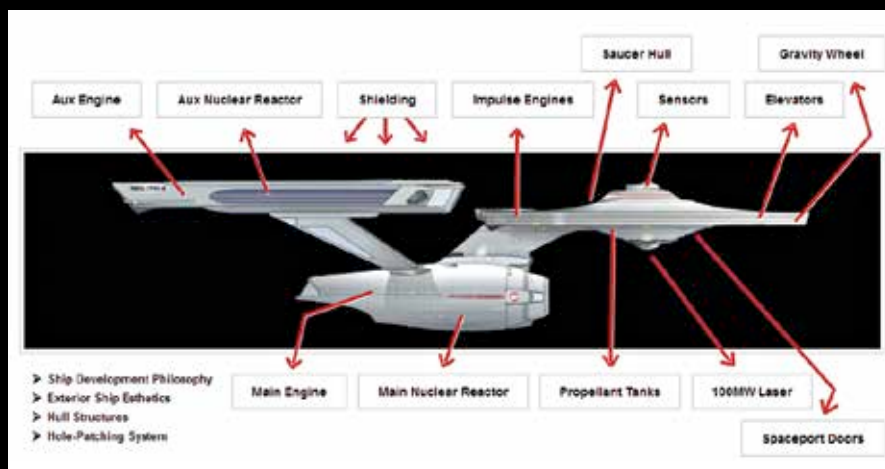
Stop! No! Don't turn over!

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If there is one fact in the world, it's that there have been a gazillion attempts at analysing the technology used in one of the most celebrated geek franchises known to man – *Star Trek*. Aficionados have spent countless hours drooling over the literally fantastic worlds depicted as 2250 AD in the legendary series. But we are not here to add to all the hype. We are here because we have come across some of the things that might interest fellow Trekkies, because they (or the plans to build them) are already in existence!

## The Starship Enterprise

Surveys show that it's the dream of approximately 100% of nerds, geeks and closet fanboys to be aboard (to say nothing of commandeering) the very crux of the entire show (and let's face it, if you're reading this magazine, you definitely fall in one of the categories to a respectable degree). And it is indeed the most seemingly improbable of concepts to implement – it's like, we haven't even built the transporter yet, and you want to hang the freakin' mothership out in the sky? Our thoughts exactly, until we encountered the sneaky plans of Mr. BTE-Dan at [buildtheenterprise.org](http://buildtheenterprise.org). This gentleman has actually laid out the entire plan for building our very own 'Gen1 USS Enterprise Spacecraft', having successfully managed to find theoretically viable alternatives to the parts of the show that are still sci-fi. And although this might not be an exact case of causality, but the US Government (who else?) have suddenly started funding the underlying technologies that the said gentleman has proposed. For



What an actual starship should look like. Oh please God please...

example, the Department of Energy has recently amped-up its work on LENR – Low Energy Nuclear Reactions. This does not directly endorse the whole Starship project, but it is a start nonetheless. But assuming that he receives appropriate backing from the upper echelons of administration, seems he has a pretty solid groundwork to start building his own fleet of the legendary ships from the show, which would serve almost the exact same purpose as they did

## Explained – The real-life Starship Enterprise plans

If you're anything like us, you've probably jumped here directly from the ship-building part. And even if it is not so, we can all still agree in that it is a pretty darn cool plan. So we decided to go into deeper lengths in order to investigate exactly what has been going on here. We think that anybody who goes for this level of detail for laying out what is essentially a childhood fantasy, deserves to make some sort of a dent in making it happen.

on the said show, and that too in the next 25 years! Not bad for 2038, right?

## The Transporter Beam

Right now, the voices in our heads are collectively shouting 'transporter', for some reason. The tractor beams are here! You could soon be hearing "Beam me up, Scotty" pretty generously if photos are later discovered capable of speech. MIT's Technology Review has us believe that photos have been 'transported' to distances up to as much as 100 kms. Disappointingly, this is not the kind of transportation that you would want it to be – it is 'Quantum Teleportation', which as of yet, cannot transport matter but data. So while you might get unbelievable speeds in data transportation and communicative channels, but actually being the one to be transported is sort of a bad idea. The reason is that Quantum Transportation is not exactly transportation – it is actually building a copy at a remote location that is exactly like the original. While this is not harmful for inanimate data, you would probably not want a clone walking the earth in your place